

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

World in 1914 and Outbreak of WWI - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Triple Alliance, 1882?

A. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. B. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Triple Alliance, 1882?

A. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. B. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. C. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. D. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Triple Alliance, 1882?

A. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. B. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. C. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. D. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Triple Alliance, 1882?

A. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. B. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. C. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. D. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Franco-Russian alliance, 1894?

A. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. B. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. C. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. D. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Franco-Russian alliance, 1894?

A. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. B. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. C. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. D. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Franco-Russian alliance, 1894?

A. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. B. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Franco-Russian alliance, 1894?

A. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. B. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. C. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. D. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Entente Cordiale, 1904?

A. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. B. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. C. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. D. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension.

Answer: A. Explanation: Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Entente Cordiale, 1904?

A. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. B. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. C. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: B. Explanation: Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Entente Cordiale, 1904?

A. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. B. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. C. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: C. Explanation: Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Entente Cordiale, 1904?

A. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. B. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. C. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. D. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Anglo-Russian agreement, 1907?

A. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. B. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. C. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Anglo-Russian agreement, 1907?

A. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. B. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. C. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. D. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Anglo-Russian agreement, 1907?

A. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. B. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. C. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Anglo-Russian agreement, 1907?

A. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. B. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. C. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. D. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Anglo-German naval rivalry?

A. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. B. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. C. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: A. Explanation: Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Anglo-German naval rivalry?

A. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. B. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. C. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. D. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival.

Answer: B. Explanation: Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Anglo-German naval rivalry?

A. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. B. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. C. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. D. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause.

Answer: C. Explanation: Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Anglo-German naval rivalry?

A. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. B. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. C. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. D. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did.

Answer: D. Explanation: Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Alsace-Lorraine and revanchism?

A. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. B. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. C. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: A. Explanation: French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Alsace-Lorraine and revanchism?

A. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. B. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. C. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. D. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause.

Answer: B. Explanation: French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Alsace-Lorraine and revanchism?

A. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. B. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. C. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. D. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.

Answer: C. Explanation: French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Alsace-Lorraine and revanchism?

A. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. B. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. C. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. D. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension.

Answer: D. Explanation: French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Bosnia Crisis, 1908?

A. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. B. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. C. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. D. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust.

Answer: A. Explanation: Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Bosnia Crisis, 1908?

A. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. B. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. C. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. D. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.

Answer: B. Explanation: Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Bosnia Crisis, 1908?

A. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. B. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. C. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. D. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.

Answer: C. Explanation: Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Bosnia Crisis, 1908?

A. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. B. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. C. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. D. Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.

Answer: D. Explanation: Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Agadir Crisis, 1911?

A. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. B. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. C. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. D. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Agadir Crisis, 1911?

A. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. B. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. C. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. D. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agadir Crisis, 1911?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. C. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. D. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agadir Crisis, 1911?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. C. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. D. The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Agadir Crisis of 1911 strengthened British support for France and deepened German mistrust. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Balkan Wars, 1912-13?

A. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. B. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. C. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. D. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Balkan Wars, 1912-13?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. C. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. D. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Balkan Wars, 1912-13?

A. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. B. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. C. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. D. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Balkan Wars, 1912-13?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. C. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. D. The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Sarajevo, 28 June 1914?

A. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. B. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. C. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. D. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.

Answer: A. Explanation: Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Sarajevo, 28 June 1914?

A. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. B. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. C. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. D. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.

Answer: B. Explanation: Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sarajevo, 28 June 1914?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. C. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. D. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914.

Answer: C. Explanation: Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sarajevo, 28 June 1914?

A. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. B. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. C. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. D. Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause.

Answer: D. Explanation: Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Austria declares war, 28 July 1914?

A. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. B. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. C. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. D. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914.

Answer: A. Explanation: Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Austria declares war, 28 July 1914?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. C. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. D. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914.

Answer: B. Explanation: Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Austria declares war, 28 July 1914?

A. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. B. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. C. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. D. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914.

Answer: C. Explanation: Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Austria declares war, 28 July 1914?

A. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. B. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. C. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. D. Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.

Answer: D. Explanation: Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies German blank cheque?

A. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. B. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. C. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. D. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.

Answer: A. Explanation: German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under German blank cheque?

A. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. B. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. C. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. D. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire.

Answer: B. Explanation: German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of German blank cheque?

A. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. B. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. C. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: C. Explanation: German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about German blank cheque?

A. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. B. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. C. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. D. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.

Answer: D. Explanation: German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Russian mobilisation?

A. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. B. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. C. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. D. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire.

Answer: A. Explanation: Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Russian mobilisation?

A. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. B. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. C. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: B. Explanation: Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Russian mobilisation?

A. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. B. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. C. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: C. Explanation: Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Russian mobilisation?

A. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. B. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. C. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. D. Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.

Answer: D. Explanation: Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Germany declares war, 1 and 3 August?

A. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. B. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. C. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. D. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914.

Answer: A. Explanation: Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Germany declares war, 1 and 3 August?

A. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. B. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. C. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. D. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire.

Answer: B. Explanation: Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Germany declares war, 1 and 3 August?

A. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. B. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. C. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. D. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics.

Answer: C. Explanation: Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Germany declares war, 1 and 3 August?

A. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. B. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. C. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. D. Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914.

Answer: D. Explanation: Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Belgium and British entry, 4 August?

A. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. B. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. C. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: A. Explanation: German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Belgium and British entry, 4 August?

A. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. B. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. C. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: B. Explanation: German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Belgium and British entry, 4 August?

A. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. B. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. C. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. D. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

Answer: C. Explanation: German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different

chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Belgium and British entry, 4 August?

A. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. B. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. C. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. D. German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914.

Answer: D. Explanation: German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Balkan nationalism?

A. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. B. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. C. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: A. Explanation: Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Balkan nationalism?

A. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. B. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. C. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. D. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

Answer: B. Explanation: Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Balkan nationalism?

A. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. B. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. C. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. D. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered.

Answer: C. Explanation: Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Balkan nationalism?

A. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. B. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. C. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. D. Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire.

Answer: D. Explanation: Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Balance-of-power structure?

A. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. B. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. C. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. D. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics.

Answer: A. Explanation: Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Balance-of-power structure?

A. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. B. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. C. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. D. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics.

Answer: B. Explanation: Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Balance-of-power structure?

A. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. B. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. C. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. D. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered.

Answer: C. Explanation: Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Balance-of-power structure?

A. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. B. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Answer: D. Explanation: Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Mobilisation rigidity and miscalculation?

A. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. B. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. C. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. D. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics.

Answer: A. Explanation: Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Mobilisation rigidity and miscalculation?

A. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. B. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered.

Answer: B. Explanation: Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Mobilisation rigidity and miscalculation?

A. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. B. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. C. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. D. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915.

Answer: C. Explanation: Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Mobilisation rigidity and miscalculation?

A. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. B. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. C. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. D. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

Answer: D. Explanation: Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Responsibility at two levels?

A. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. B. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915.

Answer: A. Explanation: Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Responsibility at two levels?

A. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. B. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. C. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. D. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Responsibility at two levels?

A. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. B. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. C. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. D. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.

Answer: C. Explanation: Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Responsibility at two levels?

A. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. B. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. C. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. D. Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics.

Answer: D. Explanation: Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Balance-of-power verdict?

A. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. B. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Balance-of-power verdict?

A. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. B. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. C. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. D. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.

Answer: B. Explanation: Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Balance-of-power verdict?

A. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. B. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. C. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. D. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did.

Answer: C. Explanation: Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Balance-of-power verdict?

A. Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. B. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. C. French resentment over Alsace-Lorraine, lost in 1871, remained a national-territorial source of tension. D. Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered.

Answer: D. Explanation: Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	12	First World War fought for preservation of balance of power	Comment · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/​examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- First World War fought for preservation of balance of power

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I · 15 marks · 250 words

Demand: How far is it correct to say that the First World War was fought essentially for the preservation of balance of power?

Status: Exact wording verified in the local owner.

Model solution: Balance of power explains the framework: two counterweighted alignments, German encirclement fears, Anglo-German naval ratios, Russian-Austrian rivalry and Britain's concern over Belgium. Yet it does not fully explain purpose or timing. Austria-Hungary sought imperial survival against South Slav nationalism; Serbia sought national expansion; France retained the Alsace-Lorraine grievance; Germany considered preventive advantage; and Russian mobilisation, German operational planning and specific July decisions converted danger into war. Thus balance of power was the structure through which competing motives were transmitted, not the essential motive shared by every belligerent.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I · 15 marks · 250 words”, every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise five named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I · 15 marks · 250 words”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Balance of power explains the framework: two counterweighted alignments, German encirclement fears, Anglo-German naval ratios, Russian-Austrian rivalry and Britain's concern over Belgium. Yet it does not fully explain purpose or timing. Austria-Hungary sought imperial survival against South Slav nationalism; Serbia sought national expansion; France retained the Alsace-Lorraine grievance; Germany considered preventive advantage; and Russian mobilisation, German operational planning and specific July decisions converted danger into war. Thus balance of power was the structure through which competing motives were transmitted, not the essential motive shared by every belligerent.

Qualification: Treat the stated causal weight as bounded by the question's period, geography and evidence status; do not convert it into inevitability or a universal civilisational claim.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why did the Balkans become the ignition zone of the First World War? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Serbian national expansion threatened Habsburg imperial survival while Russia and Germany converted the regional dispute into a great-power test.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.
- The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival.
- Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire.
- Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.

Qualified conclusion: Serbian national expansion threatened Habsburg imperial survival while Russia and Germany converted the regional dispute into a great-power test.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why did the Balkans become the ignition zone of the First World War? Answer in about 150...", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise three named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For "Why did the Balkans become the ignition zone of the First World War? Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Serbian national expansion threatened Habsburg imperial survival while Russia and Germany converted the regional dispute into a great-power test.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Serbian national expansion threatened Habsburg imperial survival while Russia and Germany converted the regional dispute into a great-power test.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: How did mobilisation planning widen the July Crisis? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Russian mobilisation and German planning through Belgium compressed diplomacy and drew France and Britain into a local Austro-Serb war.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.
- Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914.
- German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914.
- Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

Qualified conclusion: Russian mobilisation and German planning through Belgium compressed diplomacy and drew France and Britain into a local Austro-Serb war.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “How did mobilisation planning widen the July Crisis? Answer in about 150 words.”, every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise three named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “How did mobilisation planning widen the July Crisis? Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Russian mobilisation and German planning through Belgium compressed diplomacy and drew France and Britain into a local Austro-Serb war.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Russian mobilisation and German planning through Belgium compressed diplomacy and drew France and Britain into a local Austro-Serb war.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: How far did alliances cause the First World War? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Alliances structured escalation and encirclement fears but did not compel war; specific July decisions, nationalism and imperial insecurity remained decisive.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915.
- The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement.
- Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation.
- The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.
- German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.
- Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

Qualified conclusion: Alliances structured escalation and encirclement fears but did not compel war; specific July decisions, nationalism and imperial insecurity remained decisive.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "How far did alliances cause the First World War? Answer in about 250 words.", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise five named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “How far did alliances cause the First World War? Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Alliances structured escalation and encirclement fears but did not compel war; specific July decisions, nationalism and imperial insecurity remained decisive.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Alliances structured escalation and encirclement fears but did not compel war; specific July decisions, nationalism and imperial insecurity remained decisive.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Who bears responsibility for the outbreak of war? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Vienna chose war against Serbia and Berlin enabled it, while Russian mobilisation and a militarised alliance system widened responsibility without erasing agency.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.
- German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.
- Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.
- Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics.

Qualified conclusion: Vienna chose war against Serbia and Berlin enabled it, while Russian mobilisation and a militarised alliance system widened responsibility without erasing agency.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Who bears responsibility for the outbreak of war? Answer in about 250 words.", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise five named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For "Who bears responsibility for the outbreak of war? Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Vienna chose war against Serbia and Berlin enabled it, while Russian mobilisation and a militarised alliance system widened responsibility without erasing agency.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Immediate responsibility centres on Vienna's decision for war and Berlin's support, while systemic responsibility lies in militarised blocs, nationalism and prestige politics. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its

chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Vienna chose war against Serbia and Berlin enabled it, while Russian mobilisation and a militarised alliance system widened responsibility without erasing agency.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: How far was the First World War fought for preservation of balance of power? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Balance of power organised the blocs and Britain's intervention but cannot absorb national, imperial and preventive motives; it was the transmission system, not the complete purpose.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did.
- Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat.
- Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire.
- Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing.
- Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered.

Qualified conclusion: Balance of power organised the blocs and Britain's intervention but cannot absorb national, imperial and preventive motives; it was the transmission system, not the complete purpose.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "How far was the First World War fought for preservation of balance of power? Answer in about...", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise six to eight named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For "How far was the First World War fought for preservation of balance of power? Answer in about...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Balance of power organised the blocs and Britain's intervention but cannot absorb national, imperial and preventive motives; it was the transmission system, not the complete purpose.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Germany's naval rise directly challenged Britain's relative sea power and strategic security more than colonial rivalry alone did. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia in 1908, deepening Serbian hostility and convincing Russia not to accept another humiliating retreat. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the

mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Serbian and South Slav nationalism aimed at political unification while Austria-Hungary fought to preserve a multinational empire. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Alliance blocs, encirclement fears, naval ratios and Balkan shifts made local conflict a test of great-power standing. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Balance of power explains the structure and Britain's strategic concern, but not the full motives: Habsburg survival, South Slav nationalism, revanchism and preventive calculation also mattered. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Balance of power organised the blocs and Britain's intervention but cannot absorb national, imperial and preventive motives; it was the transmission system, not the complete purpose.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Why did a Balkan crisis become a world war in 1914? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: A local assassination activated Austro-Serb hostility, German support, Russian mobilisation, operational rigidity and Belgian intervention inside a mistrustful imperial system.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival.
- Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause.
- Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914.
- German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna.
- Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time.
- Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914.
- German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914.
- Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

Qualified conclusion: A local assassination activated Austro-Serb hostility, German support, Russian mobilisation, operational rigidity and Belgian intervention inside a mistrustful imperial system.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why did a Balkan crisis become a world war in 1914? Answer in about 300 words.", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved content above is the executable answer base. Preserve its thesis, named chronology, spatial evidence, causal mechanism, counter-position and qualification rather than replacing it with a generic narrative.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise six to eight named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed

interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “Why did a Balkan crisis become a world war in 1914? Answer in about 300 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A local assassination activated Austro-Serb hostility, German support, Russian mobilisation, operational rigidity and Belgian intervention inside a mistrustful imperial system.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Balkan Wars strengthened Serbia and alarmed Austria-Hungary, which saw South Slav nationalism as a threat to imperial survival. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Gavrilo Princip assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo on 28 June 1914; the assassination was the trigger, not the complete cause. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Austria-Hungary used the assassination and ultimatum crisis to declare war on Serbia on 28 July 1914. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Russian mobilisation for Serbia transformed the Austro-Serb conflict into a direct great-power confrontation and compressed German decision time. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August and France on 3 August 1914. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** German mobilisation planning required an attack through Belgium, and violation of Belgian neutrality brought Britain into war on 4 August 1914. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: A local assassination activated Austro-Serb hostility, German support, Russian mobilisation, operational rigidity and Belgian intervention inside a mistrustful imperial system.